



INDIAN FOREST SERVICE BENEVOLENT AND WELFARE TRUST

Standing for Green Warriors

GOVERNING BODY

President

Shri A. K. Goyal

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Dr. D. D. Sharma

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Shri Vinod Kumar Tiwari

Joint Secretary

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REGISTERED OFFICE

Office of the Deputy Conservator of Forests,
Department of Forests and Wildlife,
Kamla Nehru Ridge,
New Delhi- 110007

File No. IFSBWT/101/2026/13-CM (WB)

Date: August 24, 2026

To
Shri Suwendu Adhikari
Hon'ble Chief Minister,
Government of West Bengal,
Nabanna, Howrah, West Bengal.
Email: cmo@wb.gov.in

Subject: Formulation of a Comprehensive Welfare Policy for Ex-Gratia Compensation and Compassionate Appointments for Frontline Forest Personnel.

Respected Sir,

1. The Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust (IFSBWT) was constituted and registered under the Registration Act, 1908, as a nationwide charitable entity with the primary objective of providing structured welfare assistance, emergency relief, and socio-economic support to frontline forest personnel and their families across the country.
2. We respectfully draw your kind attention to a major institutional policy gap concerning the welfare and institutional protection of the frontline "foot soldiers" of the West Bengal Forest Department, necessary to ensure the fast-tracked rehabilitation of the next of kin of field-level officials who die in harness while safeguarding the state's natural heritage.
3. West Bengal holds a highly sensitive position on India's ecological and geopolitical map. Managing 11,879 square kilometres of Recorded Forest Area (13.38% of the state's geography), the state's forest department protects critical habitats like the Sundarbans, Buxa, Jaldapara, and Gorumara. Crucially, the narrow "Chicken's Neck" (Siliguri Corridor) acts as a hyper-vulnerable geopolitical bottleneck flanked by Nepal, Bhutan, and Bangladesh. This places frontline forest staff at the absolute epicentre of transnational enforcement, requiring risky, high-stakes intelligence operations to intercept heavily armed international syndicates trafficking local and exotic contraband.
4. Behind West Bengal's conservation triumphs lies a quiet narrative of profound human sacrifice. The forestry personnel manage treacherous terrains under high-risk conditions—combating wildlife depredation, navigating tiger-infested waters, and fighting armed timber mafias with minimal protection. In the past two years alone, West Bengal has lost or seen grievously injured the following frontline personnel in the line of duty:

- a. Late Shri Rithey Subba (Forest Guard): Trampled to death on November 4, 2023, inside the Jaldapara Wildlife Sanctuary while executing a high-risk elephant-interception drive, during which a critical equipment malfunction caused his service firearm to jam.
 - b. Late Shri Ali Miyan (Forest Guard): Trampled to death by a wild elephant in the Pukhri area of the Jayanti Range on March 3, 2024, while performing duties during a tiger-herbivore census in the Buxa Tiger Reserve.
 - c. Late Shri Dulal Rava (Forest Worker): Attacked and killed by a wild bison on July 3, 2025, while conducting a routine patrol in the Malangi Beat of Jaldapara National Park.
 - d. Shri Ganesh Shyamal (Temporary Support Worker): Grievously mauled by a Royal Bengal Tiger on February 10, 2025, while attempting to cordon off a straying tiger near Nagenabad village in the Sundarbans Tiger Reserve.
 - e. Late Shri Chandrakanta Mandal (Casual Labourer, Hula Party Member): Trampled to death by a wild elephant while trying to divert a herd approaching an agricultural field in Jhargram's Chitalbani village.
 - f. Late Shri Rajkumar Oraon (Contractual Worker): Fatally trampled when an elephant went berserk while he was performing wildlife management duties in the Kunjanagar beat of Jaldapara; being a non-regular employee, his family was left without any institutional support.
5. The sudden loss of these breadwinners leaves their families in profound distress – a vulnerability most acute for non-regular workers who lack structural safety nets. West Bengal, with an estimated workforce of 12,000 to 15,000 field-level personnel across all categories, currently lacks a uniform framework guaranteeing financial and employment parity with the State Police. We would respectfully suggest benchmarking against the precedent set by the Government of Maharashtra, which provides, inter alia:
 - a. **Ex-Gratia Financial Parity:** A standard, non-discretionary lump-sum payment of ₹50 Lakhs, uniform regardless of the cause of death, credited directly to the next of kin within a fixed timeline.
 - b. **Immediate Employment Security:** Fast-tracked compassionate appointments in public services for an eligible family member to secure the family's future, explicitly encompassing temporary, casual, and contractual personnel who die in the line of duty.
 6. The precise funding architecture for this framework is naturally a matter for your Government to determine. We leave the final decision on the funding mechanism entirely to your Government's discretion. A copy of the Government of Maharashtra Resolution dated October 12, 2022, in original Marathi and English translation, is enclosed as a working model.
 7. Securing the dignity and security of our fallen personnel's families would be the single most powerful step to boost the morale of the thousands of frontline workers guarding West Bengal's forests. We are confident that under your

empathetic leadership, the Government of West Bengal will give this proposal its early and favourable consideration.

Thanking you,

Yours sincerely,



A K Goyal
President

Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust (IFSBWT)

Mobile: 9910647881

Encl: Government of Maharashtra Resolution dated October 12, 2022 (Marathi and English versions).

Copy for kind information and necessary action to (not on original):
Chief Secretary, Government of West Bengal
The PCCF (HoFF), Government of West Bengal

वन विभागांतर्गत कार्यरत असलेल्या अधिकारी/ कर्मचारी यांचा वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर/ शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करतांना मृत्यू झाल्यास व कायमचे अपंगत्व आल्यास त्यांचे वारसास लाभ देण्याबाबत.

महाराष्ट्र शासन

महसूल व वन विभाग

शासन निर्णय क्र. एफएसटी-११/२१/प्र. क्र.२४८/ फ-४

हुतात्मा राजगुरु चौक, मादाम कामा रोड,

मंत्रालय, मुंबई-४०० ०३२.

दिनांक: १२ ऑक्टोबर, २०२२.

संदर्भ: १) महसूल व वन विभाग, शासन निर्णय क्र.टिआरएस-१०९८/प्रक्र.१९०/फ-६, दि.२२.९.२००८
२) अपर प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (प्रशासन व दुय्यम संवर्ग), नागपूर यांचे पत्र क्र.कक्ष- १०(२)/ आस्था/एक/प्रक्र.४६ (१७-१८)/१०८, दि.९.९.२०२०

प्रस्तावना:

राज्यात दि.२२.९.२००८ च्या शासन निर्णयान्वये वन धोरण करण्यात आलेले आहे. सदर वन धोरणात नैसर्गिक व मानव निर्मित वनांचे संरक्षण आणि व्यवस्थापन या अंतर्गत वनसंरक्षणाचे कर्तव्य पार पाडतांना कोणत्याही वन अधिकारी /कर्मचारी यांचा मृत्यू झाल्यास अथवा अपंग झाल्यास अशा बाधित वन अधिकारी/ कर्मचारी यांना किंवा त्यांच्या नातेवाईकांना पोलीस खात्यात चालू असलेल्या पध्दतीप्रमाणे नुकसान भरपाई व आर्थिक मदत दिली जाईल असे ठरविण्यात आले आहे.

मानवाला तसेच पशु पक्षांना अनेक प्रकारे उपयोगी ठरणान्या वनाचे संरक्षण करणे अत्यंत आवश्यक आहे. वनसंरक्षणाचे कर्तव्य पार पाडत असतांना वन अधिकारी/कर्मचारी यांचे काही वेळा प्राण जातात अथवा गंभीररित्या जखमी होतात. या सर्व बाबी विचारात घेता, वन विभागांतर्गत कार्यरत असलेल्या अधिकारी/कर्मचारी यांचा वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर/ शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करतांना मृत्यू झाल्यास व कायमचे अपंग झाल्यास अशा कर्मचाऱ्यांच्या कुटुंबियांना वा बाधित वन अधिकारी/कर्मचारी यांना महाराष्ट्र राज्यातील पोलीस विभागाच्या तसेच इतर राज्यात देण्यात येणाऱ्या नुकसान भरपाईच्या धर्तीवर नुकसान भरपाई तसेच इतर सोयी सुविधा देण्याची बाब शासनाच्या विचाराधीन होती.

शासन निर्णय:

वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर/ शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करताना मृत्यू पावलेल्या / कायमचे अपंगत्व आलेल्या अधिकारी/कर्मचाऱ्यांच्या वारसांना खालीलप्रमाणे नुकसान भरपाई तसेच इतर सोयी सुविधा मंजूर करण्यात येत आहेत.

(१) नुकसान भरपाई :-

अ. क्र.	पदनाम / श्रेणी	मृत्यू पावल्यास	कायमचे अपंगत्व आल्यास
१	गट-अ व त्यावरील अधिकारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,६०,०००/-
२	गट- ब अधिकारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,३०,०००/-
३	गट- क कर्मचारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,००,०००/-
४	गट- ड कर्मचारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,००,०००/-

वरीलप्रमाणे रु.२५ लक्ष नुकसान भरपाई ही कायदेशीर वारसदारांच्या संयुक्त नावाने मुदत ठेव म्हणून देण्यात येईल. सदर रक्कम १० वर्षांपर्यंत काढता येणार नाही. व्याज रक्कम दर महिन्याला घेता येईल. मुदत ठेवीची रक्कम फक्त अपवादात्मक परिस्थितीत व तसे नियुक्ती प्राधिकाऱ्याने प्रमाणित केल्यास ५ वर्षांनंतर काढून घेता येईल.

- (२) वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर / शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करतांना मृत्यू पावलेल्या वन अधिकारी / कर्मचाऱ्याच्या कुटुंबात अनुकंपा नियुक्तीस पात्र उमेदवार नसल्यास अगर वारसाने अनुकंपा नियुक्ती स्विकारण्यास नकार दिल्यास, मृत अधिकारी / कर्मचारी जणू काही मृत झाली नाही असे मानून सदर अधिकारी / कर्मचारी सेवेत असते तर मृत्यूच्यावेळी जे पद धारण करीत होते त्या पदावरून वरच्या पदावर पदोन्नतीसाठी ज्या ज्या वेळी पात्र ठरली असती त्या-त्या वेळी सदर व्यक्ती पदोन्नत झाली असे गृहीत धरून त्या अधिकारी/कर्मचाऱ्याची वेतन निश्चिती करण्यात यावी. त्यानुसार पदोन्नतीच्या पदावर निश्चित करण्यात आलेले वेतन मृत वन अधिकारी / कर्मचाऱ्याच्या नियत वयोमानानुसार सेवानिवृत्तीच्या दिनांकापर्यंत देण्यात यावे. सदर वेतन वार्षिक वेतनवाढीसह देण्यात यावे.
- (३) मृत्यूमुखी पडलेल्या वन अधिकारी / कर्मचारी यांचे पार्थिव देह रेल्वे, बस व ॲम्बुलन्स इत्यादी प्रकारच्या वाहनाद्वारे नेण्याचा सर्व खर्च व पार्थिव देहाबरोबर एका व्यक्तिला जाण्यासाठी येणारा खर्च शासनातर्फे करण्यात यावा.
- (४) जखमी वन अधिकारी / कर्मचारी यांचा राज्यांतर्गत औषधोपचारांचा व शस्त्रक्रियेचा रुग्णालयातील सर्व खर्च राज्य शासनातर्फे देण्यात यावा.

हा शासन निर्णय निर्गमित केल्याच्या दिनांकापासून अंमलात येईल.

२. सदर शासन निर्णय महाराष्ट्र शासनाच्या www.maharashtra.gov.in या संकेतस्थळावर उपलब्ध करण्यात आला असून त्याचा संकेतांक २०२२१०१२११२८१००३१९ असा आहे. हा आदेश डिजीटल स्वाक्षरीने साक्षांकित करून काढण्यात येत आहे.

महाराष्ट्राचे राज्यपाल यांच्या आदेशानुसार व नावाने,

RAVIKIRAN

SABAJI GOVEKAR

(डॉ. रविकिरण गोवेकर)

मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (मंत्रालय)

Digitally signed by RAVIKIRAN SABAJI GOVEKAR
DN: c=IN, o=GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA, ou=REVENUE
AND FOREST DEPARTMENT,
2.5.4.20=b00b3a6f82b447bdd60190209f1258e170f8617d261f
81e5281d1bf6f28cd, postalCode=400032, st=Maharashtra,
serialNumber=8752370855700A3E58B4B069230BC54F6A13D04
798D2EE7A3F1C7DCC5655271C, cn=RAVIKIRAN SABAJI
GOVEKAR
Date: 2022.10.12 11:30:28 +05'30'

प्रत,

१. मा. राज्यपाल यांचे सचिव, राजभवन, मलबार हिल, मुंबई,
२. मा. मुख्यमंत्री यांचे प्रधान सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
३. मा. उपमुख्यमंत्री यांचे प्रधान सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
४. मा. मंत्री (वने) यांचे खाजगी सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
५. सर्व मा. मंत्री यांचे खाजगी सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
६. मा. विरोधी पक्ष नेता, विधान परिषद/ विधान सभा, महाराष्ट्र विधानमंडळ सचिवालय, मुंबई,
७. मा. मुख्य सचिव यांचे वरिष्ठ स्वीय सहाय्यक, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
८. सर्व मंत्रालयीन विभाग, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,

९. सर्व मंत्रालयीन विभागाचे अमुस/प्र.स./सचिव,
१०. सचिव, मा. सभापती, विधानपरिषद, विधानमंडळ, मुंबई,
११. सचिव, मा. अध्यक्ष, विधानसभा, विधानमंडळ, मुंबई,
१२. महालेखापाल -१ व २ (लेखा व अनुज्ञेयता)/(लेखापरीक्षा), महाराष्ट्र राज्य, मुंबई/नागपूर
१३. प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (वनबल प्रमुख), महाराष्ट्र राज्य, नागपूर
१४. प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (वन्यजीव), महाराष्ट्र राज्य, नागपूर.
१५. प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक, सामाजिक वनीकरण, महाराष्ट्र राज्य, पुणे.
१६. अपर प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक, (सर्व)
१७. मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (सर्व)/वनसंरक्षक (सर्व) / उप वनसंरक्षक (सर्व) / विभागीय वन अधिकारी (सर्व)
१८. जिल्हा कोषागार अधिकारी (सर्व),
१९. निवडनस्ती, फ-४ कार्यासन महसूल व वन विभाग, मंत्रालय, मुंबई.

Subject: Regarding the grant of benefits to the heirs of officers/employees working under the Forest Department in the event of death or permanent disability caused by forest fire, wild animal attack, attack by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals.

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA

Revenue and Forest Department

Government Resolution No. FST-11/21/Pra.Kra.248/F-4

Hutatma Rajguru Chowk, Madam Cama Road,

Mantralaya, Mumbai-400 032.

Date: October 12, 2022.

References:

1. Revenue and Forest Department, Government Resolution No. TRS-1098/Prakra.190/F-6, dated September 22, 2008
2. Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Administration and Subordinate Cadre), Nagpur, Letter No. Kaksha-10(2)/Astha/Ek/Prakra.46(17-18)/108, dated September 9, 2020

Preamble:

A forest policy was framed in the State vide the Government Resolution dated September 22, 2008. Under the said forest policy, it was decided that if any forest officer/employee dies or becomes disabled while discharging the duty of forest conservation under the protection and management of natural and man-made forests, such affected forest officer/employee, or their relatives, would be granted compensation and financial assistance as per the procedure prevailing in the Police Department.

It is extremely necessary to protect forests, which are useful to humans as well as to birds and animals in many ways. While discharging the duty of forest conservation, forest officers/employees sometimes lose their lives or are seriously injured. Taking all these matters into consideration, the question of providing compensation and other facilities — on the lines of the compensation given in the Police Department of the State of Maharashtra and in other States — to the families of such employees / affected forest officers/employees who die or become permanently disabled in forest fires, wild animal attacks, attacks by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals, was under the consideration of the Government.

Government Resolution:

Compensation and other facilities are hereby sanctioned as follows to the heirs of officers/employees who die or become permanently disabled in forest fires, wild animal attacks, attacks by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals.

(1) Compensation:

Sr. No.	Designation / Category	In case of death	In case of permanent disability
1	Group-A and above officers	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,60,000/-
2	Group-B officers	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,30,000/-
3	Group-C employees	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,00,000/-
4	Group-D employees	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,00,000/-

The compensation of Rs. 25 lakh as above shall be given as a fixed deposit in the joint name of the legal heirs. The said amount shall not be withdrawable for 10 years. The interest amount may be drawn every month. The fixed deposit amount may be withdrawn after 5 years only in exceptional circumstances and if so certified by the appointing authority.

(2) If there is no candidate eligible for compassionate appointment in the family of the forest officer/employee who died in a forest fire, wild animal attack, attack by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals, or if the heir refuses to accept compassionate appointment, then — presuming as if the deceased officer/employee had not died — the pay of such officer/employee shall be fixed by assuming that, had the said officer/employee remained in service, the person would have been promoted on each occasion on which they would have become eligible for promotion to a higher post from the post held at the time of death. Accordingly, the pay fixed at the promotional post shall be paid up to the date of superannuation as per the prescribed retirement age of the deceased forest officer/employee. The said pay shall be given along with annual increments.

(3) The entire cost of transporting the mortal remains of the deceased forest officer/employee by means such as railway, bus, ambulance, etc., as well as the cost incurred for one person to travel along with the mortal remains, shall be borne by the Government.

(4) The entire cost of medical treatment and surgery within the State, in hospital, for injured forest officers/employees shall be borne by the State Government.

This Government Resolution shall come into effect from the date of its issue.

2. This Government Resolution has been made available on the Government of Maharashtra website www.maharashtra.gov.in, and its code is **202210121128100319**. This order is being issued with digital signature authentication.

By order and in the name of the Governor of Maharashtra,

(Dr. Ravikiran Govekar)

Chief Conservator of Forests (Mantralaya)

Copy to:

1. Secretary to the Hon. Governor, Rajbhavan, Malabar Hill, Mumbai
2. Principal Secretary to the Hon. Chief Minister, Mantralaya, Mumbai
3. Principal Secretary to the Hon. Deputy Chief Minister, Mantralaya, Mumbai
4. Private Secretary to the Hon. Minister (Forests), Mantralaya, Mumbai
5. Private Secretaries to all Hon. Ministers, Mantralaya, Mumbai
6. Hon. Leader of the Opposition, Legislative Council / Legislative Assembly, Maharashtra Legislature Secretariat, Mumbai
7. Senior Personal Assistant to the Hon. Chief Secretary, Mantralaya, Mumbai
8. All Mantralaya Departments, Mantralaya, Mumbai
9. Additional Chief Secretary / Principal Secretary / Secretary of all Mantralaya Departments
10. Secretary to the Hon. Chairman, Legislative Council, Legislature, Mumbai
11. Secretary to the Hon. Speaker, Legislative Assembly, Legislature, Mumbai
12. Accountant General -1 and 2 (Accounts and Entitlement) / (Audit), Maharashtra State, Mumbai/Nagpur
13. Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Head of Forest Force), Maharashtra State, Nagpur
14. Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Wildlife), Maharashtra State, Nagpur
15. Principal Chief Conservator of Forests, Social Forestry, Maharashtra State, Pune
16. Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (All)
17. Chief Conservator of Forests (All) / Conservator of Forests (All) / Deputy Conservator of Forests (All) / Divisional Forest Officer (All)
18. District Treasury Officer (All)
19. Select File, F-4 Section, Revenue and Forest Department, Mantralaya, Mumbai